

WhatsApp outage

A few days after the \$19 billion mega buyout was announced, WhatsApp experienced an outage caused by a router apparently. Details: <http://dgit.in/wappout>

**First 5TB external drive**

Storage device manufacturer - Lacie, recently announced a 5TB, 7200 RPM hard drive which would be available in a single shell

Smart Ways

to improve your productivity using technology

There's always scope to do more stuff, do it quicker and more efficiently.

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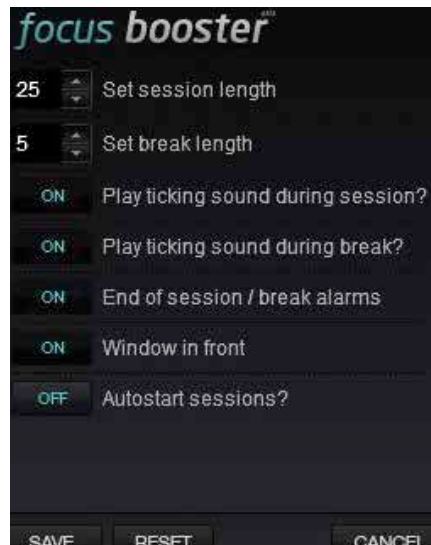
Goofing off is something we've all been guilty of at some point or the other. Keeping track of deadlines, remembering stuff to do, staying focused, streamlining activities and cutting out distractions can go a long way in making you productive and organised again. The tools, tips and tech-assisted methods we feature below will help simplify and improve your life.

1 Stay focused!

Staying focused on the task at hand pushes you a step closer towards its accomplishment. You could be a champion at multitasking, nevertheless, this isn't without its disadvantages and chances are high that mistakes may creep in. Say you're completing a project at office while simultaneously making fun of your boss on Twitter (if you're lucky enough to not have it blocked at work or have your activities monitored). Imagine the consequences if you mixed up the tasks!

Focus Booster

Focus Booster is a widget-like desktop-based timer application based on the 'pomodoro' technique – a time management method developed by Francesco Cirillo in the late 1980s – which estimates that we're most productive when we work in intervals traditionally lasting 25 minutes in length, separated by short breaks. These timed blocks are known as 'pomodoros'. The app has a narrow looking rectangular interface that holds a counter set



Focus your energies on the task at hand by working in sessions using this app

to 25 minutes, ready to play. A small "i" on the interface brings up a pop up with options that let you set up the session, choose the break length, activate sounds and select an "always-on-top" option. However, it's not possible for you to enjoy breaks lasting more than five minutes. Upon clicking the play button, the countdown begins with a brief stopwatch-like sound and displays "Session 01" on the screen. When the first session ends, an alarm bell notifies you that it's break time at the end of which the next session begins automatically. Download Focus Booster: <http://dgit.in/focusboosterapp>

2 Do things on time

Do the number of tasks you need to perform overwhelm you, making you forget some of the important tasks

in that list, or god forbid, a deadline? This happens due to unorganised to-do lists. Here are some tools to the rescue:

Todo.ly

Earlier, working on different tasks and projects simultaneously was a tough ordeal. Today, we have Todo.ly. This online web application has several features, which help you organise your tasks efficiently. By using Todo.ly, you can not only create tasks and projects, but also move the tasks into the existing projects. All you need to do is create/assign tasks to the desired dates, and as the deadline approaches, tasks will start popping up in your "Today" list. Therefore, you can't easily forget or run away from your tasks. Additionally, its several filters let you set reminder emails to be delivered right into your inbox for any task. It's available as a web application accessible right from your web browser and as an iOS app. Todo.ly can be downloaded at: <http://todo.ly/>. iOS users, download Todo.ly from the iTunes store at: <http://dgit.in/todolyios>

Any.do

Unlike Todo.ly, Any.do is designed to work across mobile devices and on computers with Chrome installed. Available as an Android/iOS app and as a Chrome extension, Any.do synchronises your tasks on all platforms that have the app installed. On Any.do, you can drag and drop your tasks and to-dos within the app's interface, or attach notes to any existing task. Additionally, if you're using the Chrome extension, you'll get a new "Remind Me"